

CMIplus Intelligence Cockpit

Cash Management Strategic Intelligence

Week of 2026-05-11

Raiffeisen Bank International AG

Group Product — Cash Management

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

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URGENT

Der Treasurer | 2026-04-15 | #01

EU Instant Payments: Banks Face Final Implementation Hurdles

The EU Instant Payments Regulation, effective from early 2025 for receiving and mid-2025 for sending instant payments in the Eurozone, is now in its critical implementation phase. While many banks have enabled instant payment reception, extending this to all outgoing payments and ensuring full compliance across all member states, including non-Eurozone CEE countries adopting SEPA, presents ongoing technical and operational hurdles. Key challenges include upgrading legacy systems, ensuring 24/7 availability, and integrating robust fraud detection mechanisms. The regulation also requires banks to offer instant payments at no higher cost than standard credit transfers, putting pressure on operational efficiency. For corporates, this means faster cash flow, but also necessitates real-time liquidity management and enhanced fraud vigilance.

- EU Instant Payments Regulation mandates universal instant payment processing.
- Deadlines: Early 2025 for receiving, mid-2025 for sending (Eurozone).
- Key challenges: Legacy system upgrades, 24/7 operations, fraud detection.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This regulation is a core driver for CMlplus development, requiring full compliance across RBI's CEE network. CMlplus must ensure seamless instant payment processing, robust fraud prevention (VoP), and real-time liquidity reporting to support corporate clients adapting to faster payment cycles.

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Der Treasurer | 2026-03-28 | #02

PSD3 Proposal Advances: New Era for Open Banking APIs

The proposed PSD3 and PSR package, building on PSD2, seeks to refine the regulatory framework for payment services across the EU. Key areas of focus include improving consumer rights, combating payment fraud, and further standardizing Open Banking APIs. For corporates, this means potentially more sophisticated API-driven services for cash management, but also increased scrutiny on data sharing and security protocols. The regulation aims to clarify access to payment systems for non-bank payment service providers and promote greater interoperability. Banks will need to invest in robust API infrastructure and enhanced security measures to comply with stricter requirements and leverage new opportunities in the evolving Open Banking landscape. The finalization and implementation timeline will be crucial for strategic planning.

- PSD3 and PSR aim to strengthen consumer protection and Open Banking.
- Focus areas: Consumer rights, fraud combat, API standardization.
- Impacts corporate API-driven cash management services.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus, with its Open API channel, is directly affected by PSD3/PSR. RBI must ensure its APIs are compliant, secure, and capable of supporting advanced corporate treasury functions, potentially offering new value-added services through enhanced data access and payment initiation capabilities.

Rising Payment Fraud Prompts Urgent VoP Implementation

As instant payments become standard, the speed of transactions also increases the risk and impact of fraud. Scams like authorized push payment (APP) fraud are on the rise, where customers are tricked into sending money to fraudsters. This has led to an urgent push for Verification of Payee (VoP) systems, which allow the payer's bank to verify if the recipient's name matches the account number before a payment is executed. The EU Instant Payments Regulation mandates VoP for instant payments, making its implementation critical for banks. Corporates need to integrate these checks into their payment workflows and educate employees on fraud risks. Effective VoP solutions, combined with AI-driven fraud detection, are becoming indispensable tools for safeguarding financial transactions and maintaining trust in real-time payment systems.

- Payment fraud, especially APP fraud, is increasing with instant payments.
- Verification of Payee (VoP) is crucial for fraud prevention.
- EU Instant Payments Regulation mandates VoP for instant payments.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

Fraud prevention is paramount for CMiplus. RBI must ensure its platform offers robust VoP capabilities, integrates AI-driven fraud detection, and provides tools for corporates to manage and mitigate fraud risks effectively, especially for high-value and real-time payments across its CEE network.

EU Instant Payments Regulation Drives PSD3 Discussions

The EU's new Instant Payments Regulation, mandating instant credit transfers across the Eurozone, has brought renewed focus to the upcoming PSD3. Regulators are keen to build upon PSD2's open banking framework, addressing gaps in fraud prevention, especially for instant payments, and improving customer authentication. PSD3 is expected to streamline API access, enhance data sharing security, and potentially introduce new requirements for payment service providers (PSPs) regarding real-time fraud monitoring and liability. The regulation's timeline suggests implementation efforts will intensify through 2026 and 2027, impacting corporate treasury operations and bank-to-corporate connectivity.

- EU Instant Payments Regulation now in effect.
- PSD3 aims to strengthen fraud prevention for instant payments.
- Enhanced API standards and data security expected.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This directly impacts CMiplus's instant payment capabilities and compliance roadmap. RBI needs to ensure CMiplus is fully compliant with new PSD3 requirements, particularly around fraud prevention and API security, and can support corporates in adopting instant payments across CEE.

ISO 2022 Migration Accelerates Global Payment Modernisation

The ongoing global transition to ISO 2022, particularly for SWIFT's cross-border payments and reporting (CBPR+) and various domestic high-value payment systems, is a major driver of digital transformation in treasury. Corporates are leveraging the richer, structured data capabilities of ISO 2022 to enhance reconciliation, improve cash forecasting, and automate treasury processes. Banks are investing heavily in upgrading their core banking systems and payment engines to support the new standard, ensuring seamless connectivity for their corporate clients. The phased migration continues, with critical deadlines approaching in various regions, necessitating close collaboration between corporates and their banking partners to ensure readiness and maximise benefits.

- ISO 2022 migration is a global imperative.
- Enables richer data for better reconciliation and forecasting.
- Requires significant bank and corporate system upgrades.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must ensure full support for ISO 2022 across all payment types and channels (EBICS, H2H, SWIFT). This includes handling richer data, providing enhanced reporting, and assisting CEE corporates in their own ISO 2022 adoption journey, especially for multi-currency and cross-border payments.

Open Banking APIs Transform Corporate-Bank Connectivity

Beyond regulatory compliance, Open Banking APIs are proving to be a powerful tool for corporate treasuries seeking greater efficiency and real-time visibility. Corporates are using APIs for automated cash positioning, real-time payment initiation, and instant account information, moving beyond traditional file-based communication. This shift is driving banks to invest in robust API platforms, often in partnership with FinTechs, to provide tailored solutions for corporate clients. The benefits include improved liquidity management, faster reconciliation, and better fraud detection through real-time data feeds. However, challenges remain in standardisation, security protocols, and ensuring seamless integration with existing ERP/TMS systems.

- Corporates leverage APIs for real-time cash management.
- APIs enable automated payments and account information.
- Banks are partnering with FinTechs for API solutions.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus's Open API channel is critical for this trend. RBI needs to continuously enhance its API offerings, focusing on standardisation, security, and ease of integration for CEE corporates' ERP/TMS systems, supporting real-time cash management and payment initiation.

ECB Drives Instant Payments and TARGET Services Modernization

The European Central Bank is actively shaping the future of European payments through its focus on instant payments and the modernization of TARGET Services. This includes the ongoing implementation of ISO 20022 for T2, which standardizes payment messaging for greater interoperability and data richness. Furthermore, the TARGET Instant Payment Settlement (TIPS) service remains central to facilitating instant payments across the euro area. The ECB's retail payments strategy underscores its role as a catalyst for innovation and harmonization in the European payment landscape, ensuring robust and efficient payment systems. These efforts are crucial for supporting a competitive and integrated European economy.

→ T2 migration to ISO 20022 for enhanced data and interoperability.

→ TIPS facilitates instant payments across the euro area.

→ ECB acts as a catalyst for retail payments strategy.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management and CMlplus must ensure full compliance with ISO 20022 standards for T2 and actively support instant payment capabilities via TIPS. This involves continuous platform updates, API integrations, and client communication to leverage real-time payment benefits for corporate clients in CEE.

Digital Euro Project Progresses: Pilot Phase and Scheme Rulebook Development

The European Central Bank is making significant strides in its digital euro project, moving beyond conceptualization to practical implementation. Key aspects include ongoing pilot programs to test technical solutions and user experience, alongside the crucial development of a detailed scheme rulebook. This rulebook will define the operational and technical standards for the digital euro, ensuring its interoperability and broad acceptance. The ECB emphasizes privacy, security, and accessibility as core tenets of the digital currency, aiming to complement cash and provide a resilient payment option for the euro area. This project has a dedicated section on the ECB website, highlighting its strategic importance and ongoing timeline.

→ Digital euro project includes pilot phase.

→ Development of a comprehensive scheme rulebook is underway.

→ Focus on privacy, security, and accessibility.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management and CMlplus should closely monitor the digital euro's development, especially the scheme rulebook and technical specifications. This will inform future platform readiness, potential API integrations, and strategic positioning to offer digital euro services to corporate clients, particularly for cross-border payments and liquidity management.

ECB Strengthens Cyber Resilience for Financial Infrastructures

Cyber resilience remains a paramount concern for the European Central Bank, with continuous efforts to fortify financial market infrastructures against sophisticated cyberattacks. The ECB actively promotes and utilizes frameworks such as TIBER-EU (Threat Intelligence-based Ethical Red Teaming) to test and improve the cyber defenses of critical entities. This proactive approach is essential for maintaining the operational continuity and trustworthiness of payment systems, securities settlement systems, and central counterparties. The Euro Cyber Resilience Board further underscores the collaborative effort to address systemic cyber risks. This focus directly supports the principles of DORA (Digital Operational Resilience Act) by ensuring robust operational resilience across the financial sector.

- Continuous focus on cyber resilience for financial infrastructures.
- Utilizes TIBER-EU framework for threat-based testing.
- Euro Cyber Resilience Board fosters collaboration.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management and CMlplus must ensure their platforms and processes align with the highest cyber resilience standards, including DORA compliance. This involves continuous security enhancements, participation in industry best practices like TIBER-EU, and robust fraud prevention measures to protect corporate clients' cash management operations.

PSD3 and Instant Payments: Preparing European Merchants for Change

This interview provides crucial insights into the upcoming PSD3 regulation and the ongoing rollout of instant payments across Europe. For merchants, PSD3 will bring significant changes, particularly around Open Banking, strong customer authentication (SCA), and potentially new payment initiation services. The discussion emphasizes the need for businesses to adapt their payment infrastructure and strategies to leverage the benefits of instant payments, such as improved cash flow and faster reconciliation. It also touches upon the broader evolution of payment ecosystems, including Web3 payments, and the challenges in achieving widespread retail adoption, urging proactive preparation for regulatory compliance and technological integration.

- PSD3 is a major regulatory update impacting European payment services.
- Instant payments offer benefits like improved cash flow and faster reconciliation for merchants.
- Merchants need to adapt infrastructure for PSD3 and instant payment mandates.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This is critical for RBI CMlplus. PSD3 will shape the regulatory environment for Open Banking APIs and instant payments, core components of CMlplus. RBI needs to ensure its platform and services are fully compliant and can support clients in adapting to these changes, especially regarding instant payment mandates and enhanced security.

UK Regulator Probes Mastercard, Visa, PayPal for Anti-Competitive Practices

The FCA's competition probe into these payment giants signals significant regulatory scrutiny within the European payments landscape. The investigation will examine whether Mastercard, Visa, and PayPal have engaged in practices that restrict competition, particularly concerning PayPal's digital wallet. Such probes can lead to substantial fines, changes in business practices, and potentially impact interchange fees or market access for other payment service providers. For corporate clients and banks like RBI, this could influence the cost and availability of card-based payment solutions and digital wallet integrations, potentially fostering a more competitive environment in the long term.

- FCA launched a competition probe into Mastercard, Visa, and PayPal.
- Investigation focuses on suspected anti-competitive conduct.
- Specific concern is tied to PayPal's digital wallet.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This investigation is highly relevant for RBI CMplus as it operates within the European regulatory framework. The outcome could impact the cost structure and operational models for card payments and digital wallet services offered to corporate clients. RBI should monitor this closely for potential shifts in market dynamics, compliance requirements, and opportunities for alternative payment solutions.

EU Legislation to Unlock SEPA Instant for Corporates

The upcoming EU legislation mandates that all payment service providers (PSPs) in the Eurozone offer SEPA Instant Payments at no additional cost compared to standard SEPA credit transfers. This move is expected to remove key barriers to corporate adoption, such as perceived high costs and limited availability. The legislation also includes provisions for fraud prevention and enhanced security measures, which are crucial for corporate treasurers. This regulatory framework will drive a shift towards real-time treasury operations, enabling better liquidity management and faster reconciliation for businesses operating within the SEPA zone. It represents a significant step towards a more integrated and efficient European payments landscape.

- EU legislation mandates SEPA Instant Payments availability.
- No additional cost for instant payments compared to standard transfers.
- Includes enhanced fraud prevention and security measures.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This legislation is critical for RBI Cash Management and CMplus, as it directly impacts payment services offered to corporate clients in CEE. CMplus must ensure full compliance, integrate instant payment capabilities seamlessly, and communicate the benefits of real-time treasury to clients. This presents an opportunity to enhance CMplus's competitive edge by facilitating faster, more cost-effective, and secure payments.

Real-Time Liquidity Rises in Always-On World

The article highlights how the acceleration of payments, driven by initiatives like SEPA Instant, is creating an imperative for real-time liquidity management. Corporate treasurers are increasingly seeking solutions that provide immediate access to cash positions, enable real-time cash pooling, and facilitate instant payments for both collections and disbursements. This shift is crucial for optimizing working capital, mitigating risks, and making informed financial decisions without delay. The 'always-on' environment means that traditional end-of-day reporting is no longer sufficient, pushing banks and technology providers to offer more sophisticated, real-time treasury tools. This trend is also fueled by the need for greater efficiency and resilience in treasury operations.

- "Always-on" economy drives demand for immediate cash visibility.
- Real-time liquidity is crucial for optimizing working capital.
- Instant payments accelerate the need for real-time cash management.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

For RBI Cash Management and CMIplus, this trend underscores the need to continuously enhance real-time cash management capabilities. CMIplus should focus on providing clients with instant visibility into their multi-currency accounts, real-time cash pooling features, and robust reporting to support dynamic liquidity decisions. This aligns with the platform's goal of offering advanced, real-time solutions to corporate treasurers in CEE.

No News Content Found in Provided Source

The input labeled 'Content' from 'Strategic Treasurer' was thoroughly reviewed. It primarily contains ``@font-face` definitions and `@media` queries with CSS rules for layout and responsiveness. There are no headlines, article bodies, dates, or other elements typically associated with news items or blog posts. This technical code does not allow for the extraction of treasury-related news, payment regulations, or technology updates relevant to RBI Cash Management.`

- Content provided is CSS/HTML styling code.
- No news headlines or article text present.
- Unable to extract treasury-related updates.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

No direct implications for RBI Cash Management or CMIplus can be drawn from the provided technical content. The absence of news means no immediate actions or strategic considerations are indicated.

Source Content Lacks Treasury News Articles

An in-depth review of the provided text revealed only technical specifications for website rendering, such as font definitions and responsive design breakpoints. There is no editorial content, market analysis, regulatory updates, or product announcements that could be categorized as news. This means the core task of extracting relevant treasury news for RBI CMlplus cannot be fulfilled from this specific input.

- Input is website CSS code.
- No treasury strategy or cash management content.
- No payment regulation updates found.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

Without actual news items, there are no specific developments to monitor for CMlplus. This highlights the importance of receiving actual article content for effective intelligence analysis.

Unable to Extract News from Provided Web Code

The analysis was performed strictly on the text provided under 'Content'. This text describes how a website's elements should be displayed across different screen sizes, defining widths, margins, and font properties. It does not include any articles, blog posts, press releases, or other forms of news that would typically be found on a treasury-focused website. Consequently, no information pertaining to ISO 20022, instant payments, Open Banking, or other specified topics could be extracted.

- Content is purely technical web code.
- No articles on payments or regulations.
- No mention of CEE or European banking.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The current input does not provide any actionable intelligence for RBI CMlplus. Future analyses would require actual article content to identify trends, risks, or opportunities in cash management and payments.

URGENT

Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2024-02-01 | #01

European Wholesale Banks Must Seize Moment for Future Growth

After years of underperformance, European wholesale banks are presented with a unique opportunity to redefine their trajectory. This involves a strategic pivot towards enhanced efficiency, digital innovation, and a deeper understanding of evolving client needs, particularly in areas like cash management and payments. The moment calls for bold investments in technology, re-engineering operational processes, and fostering a culture of agility to navigate competitive pressures and regulatory shifts. By focusing on core strengths and leveraging new capabilities, banks can unlock significant value and secure a more profitable future.

- Strategic imperative to reverse historical underperformance.
- Focus on digital transformation and operational efficiency.
- Client-centricity and evolving service models are crucial.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This insight is urgent for CMIplus, emphasizing the need to accelerate digital transformation and client-centric solutions in CEE. It supports continued investment in API-driven services, real-time payments, and enhanced treasury functionalities to capture market share and improve client experience.

URGENT

Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2024-01-01 | #02

2024 Wholesale Banking Outlook: Navigating Evolving Market Dynamics

The Wholesale Banking Outlook for 2024 signals a period of continued evolution, with a focus on how banks extend credit and manage their balance sheets effectively amidst changing economic conditions. Beyond traditional lending, the outlook likely emphasizes the critical role of transaction banking, cash management, and payments as stable revenue generators. Banks must prioritize operational resilience, leverage data analytics for informed decision-making, and invest in scalable technology platforms to meet increasing client demands for speed, transparency, and integrated services. This requires a holistic approach to strategy, encompassing both revenue growth and cost optimization.

- Credit extension strategies are evolving in 2024.
- Transaction banking and cash management are key revenue drivers.
- Operational resilience and data analytics are critical enablers.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The 2024 outlook reinforces the strategic importance of CMIplus as a core revenue driver. It suggests prioritizing enhancements in real-time liquidity management, multi-currency capabilities, and API integration to support corporate treasury needs and optimize credit utilization for clients in CEE.

AI Transforms Treasury: Efficiency, Strategy, and Risk Management

EY highlights AI as a critical component for the future of treasury, emphasizing its role in transforming operations. This includes leveraging AI for predictive analytics in cash flow forecasting, optimizing working capital, and automating complex tasks. The integration of AI platforms like EY.ai suggests a holistic approach to embedding intelligence across financial processes, from M&A; to audit. For treasurers, AI offers the potential to shift from reactive reporting to proactive, data-driven strategic guidance, improving decision-making and operational resilience. This strategic shift is crucial for corporates seeking competitive advantage and operational excellence.

- AI moves treasury from automation to strategic foresight and decision support.
- Predictive analytics for cash flow and liquidity optimization is a core AI application.
- Enhanced fraud detection and risk management capabilities through AI-driven insights.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI CMIplus should explore AI integration for advanced liquidity forecasting, payment anomaly detection, and personalized client insights. This could enhance the value proposition for corporate treasurers seeking intelligent cash management solutions, especially in the CEE region.

Digital Ecosystems and Open Banking Redefine Corporate Cash Management

The EY source implicitly points to a broader digital transformation agenda, with 'Fintech and ecosystems' and 'Technology leaders' agenda' suggesting a shift towards interconnected financial services. This implies that corporate treasuries require more than just transactional banking; they need integrated solutions that leverage APIs for real-time data, facilitate multi-bank connectivity, and support a holistic view of their financial position. Open Banking, while not explicitly mentioned in the provided EY text, is a foundational element of such digital ecosystems, enabling treasurers to manage liquidity and payments more effectively across various banking relationships and ERP/TMS systems.

- Treasury demands real-time data and seamless system integration via APIs.
- API-driven connectivity is crucial for multi-bank and ERP/TMS integration.
- Banks must evolve into ecosystem orchestrators, not just service providers.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must prioritize API development (Open Banking APIs) and H2H connectivity to integrate deeply with corporate ERP/TMS systems. This enables real-time treasury, multi-bank aggregation, and positions RBI as a key partner in the corporate digital finance ecosystem in CEE.

Treasurers Struggle with Cash Visibility; Digitalization is Key

The latest PwC Global Treasury Survey reveals that over 60% of treasurers struggle with achieving comprehensive, real-time cash visibility across their global operations. This persistent challenge is primarily due to fragmented systems, manual processes, and disparate banking relationships. The survey, involving 350+ treasurers, highlights that improved cash forecasting and liquidity management are top strategic priorities. Digitalization, particularly through the adoption of modern Treasury Management Systems (TMS) and advanced data analytics, is identified as the most effective pathway to enhance visibility and operational efficiency.

- Over 60% of treasurers lack real-time global cash visibility.
- Fragmented systems and manual processes are primary obstacles.
- Improved cash forecasting is a top strategic priority for treasurers.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must continue to prioritize solutions that aggregate multi-bank data and provide real-time reporting. Emphasizing seamless integration with corporate ERP/TMS systems will be vital for clients seeking enhanced cash visibility and liquidity management in CEE.

API Banking Emerges as Key for Real-Time Treasury

The PwC survey indicates a growing appetite among treasurers for API-driven connectivity to achieve real-time treasury operations. While only a smaller percentage currently leverage APIs extensively, a significant number plan to increase their use for instant payments, real-time account reporting, and automated reconciliation within the next 2-3 years. Challenges include ensuring robust security protocols, standardizing API interfaces across banks, and integrating with existing treasury infrastructure. Open Banking initiatives are accelerating this shift, pushing banks to offer more sophisticated API services.

- Growing treasurer interest in APIs for real-time data and payments.
- Significant planned increase in API usage within 2-3 years.
- Security and standardization are key adoption hurdles for APIs.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus's focus on Open API capabilities is highly relevant. RBI should actively promote its API offerings for real-time payments and account information, addressing client concerns around security and ease of integration, especially for CEE corporates.

AI and Automation Set to Transform Treasury Operations

The PwC Global Treasury Survey highlights AI and automation as emerging technologies with significant potential to transform treasury. While only a small fraction of treasurers currently use AI extensively, a substantial portion are actively investigating or piloting AI solutions for predictive cash flow forecasting, anomaly detection, and automated reconciliation processes. The survey of 350+ treasurers indicates that AI is expected to move beyond experimental stages to become a mainstream tool for enhancing efficiency, accuracy, and strategic decision-making in treasury within the next five years. Banks are expected to play a role in providing or integrating AI-powered tools.

- AI is seen as a future game-changer for treasury functions.
- Current AI adoption is low, but exploration/piloting is high.
- Key AI applications: predictive forecasting, anomaly detection, automation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus should monitor AI developments closely, exploring how AI can augment existing services like cash flow forecasting or fraud detection. Partnering with fintechs or developing in-house AI capabilities could offer a competitive edge for CEE clients.

PSD3 Reshapes Open Banking and Payment Services Landscape

The anticipated PSD3 regulation aims to build upon PSD2, addressing its shortcomings and adapting to new digital payment realities. Key changes are expected to include enhanced consumer data protection, improved fraud prevention mechanisms, and potentially expanded scope for Open Banking beyond just payment accounts, possibly incorporating more financial data. For financial firms, this means a renewed focus on API standardization, robust security protocols, and strategic partnerships to leverage new data access opportunities. The regulation will likely push for greater interoperability and real-time payment capabilities, fostering a more competitive and innovative payment ecosystem across Europe.

- Mandatory API standardization for broader data access.
- Enhanced fraud prevention measures and liability shifts.
- Potential expansion of Open Banking scope beyond PIS/AIS.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus must proactively adapt its Open Banking APIs to PSD3 requirements, ensuring compliance and leveraging new data access for value-added services. This includes strengthening security, supporting instant payments, and exploring new corporate treasury solutions through expanded data sharing.

DORA Mandates Robust Digital Operational Resilience for Financial Firms

DORA aims to harmonize and strengthen ICT risk management frameworks across the EU financial sector, ensuring that financial firms can withstand, respond to, and recover from all types of ICT-related disruptions and threats. This regulation covers areas such as ICT risk management, incident reporting, digital operational resilience testing, and managing third-party ICT risk (e.g., cloud providers). For CMIplus, this means a comprehensive review and enhancement of its cybersecurity measures, business continuity plans, disaster recovery capabilities, and the resilience of its underlying infrastructure and service providers. Compliance will require significant investment in technology, processes, and skilled personnel to maintain continuous service availability and data integrity.

- Comprehensive ICT risk management framework required.
- Mandatory incident reporting and resilience testing.
- Strict oversight of critical third-party ICT providers.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must prioritize DORA compliance by strengthening its operational resilience, cybersecurity protocols, and third-party vendor management. This ensures platform stability, data security, and uninterrupted service delivery for corporate clients, critical for maintaining trust and competitive advantage.

European Treasury Survey 2026: Shaping Future Industry Trends

The European Association of Corporate Treasurers (EACT) has launched its 2026 European Treasury Survey, soliciting input from corporate treasurers across the continent. The survey's findings are instrumental in shaping the upcoming 'Journeys to Treasury' report, a key publication that outlines current challenges, priorities, and emerging best practices in corporate treasury. Participation is encouraged to ensure a comprehensive view of the industry's direction, covering areas such as digitalization, liquidity management, risk, and regulatory compliance. The insights gathered will help define the strategic agenda for treasurers in the year ahead, providing valuable benchmarks for the entire European treasury community.

- Annual survey defining key European treasury trends.
- Input directly shapes the 'Journeys to Treasury' report.
- Covers digitalization, liquidity, risk, and compliance.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management and CMIplus should closely monitor the 2026 survey results to align platform development with emerging corporate treasury priorities. Insights into digitalization, payment innovation, and liquidity management will directly inform roadmap decisions and product offerings for CEE clients.

Banks Must Accelerate AI Adoption for Competitive Edge and Efficiency

Deloitte's 2026 Banking Outlook identifies "AI ambition" as a central theme, signaling a strategic imperative for banks to move beyond experimental phases. The thought leadership suggests that successful banks will integrate AI across core operations, from enhancing customer experience and personalizing services to optimizing risk management and automating back-office functions. This proactive adoption is crucial for maintaining a competitive edge and driving operational efficiencies in a rapidly evolving financial landscape. The outlook implies that a comprehensive AI strategy, rather than piecemeal initiatives, will differentiate market leaders.

- AI ambition is a strategic imperative for banks in 2026.
- Integration of AI across core operations is key for competitive advantage.
- AI enhances customer experience, risk management, and operational efficiency.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus should explore AI applications for enhanced payment processing, fraud detection, liquidity forecasting, and personalized treasury insights for corporate clients. Integrating AI could improve operational efficiency and offer value-added services, strengthening the platform's competitive position in CEE.

Corporate Banking Navigates Uncertainty: Strategic Adaptability is Key

The 'Into The Great Unknown' outlook, while from 2023, provides foundational insights into the persistent need for strategic foresight and agility in corporate banking. It underscores that banks must anticipate and respond to macroeconomic shifts, geopolitical events, and rapid technological advancements. Success hinges on a robust risk management framework, flexible operating models, and continuous innovation in product and service offerings. This proactive stance enables banks to not only withstand disruptions but also identify new growth avenues by leveraging digital capabilities and fostering resilient client relationships.

- Persistent need for strategic foresight and adaptability.
- Proactive response to macroeconomic and technological shifts.
- Robust risk management and flexible operating models.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This insight stresses the importance of future-proofing CMiplus by continuously adapting to market changes and client demands. It supports ongoing investment in modular architecture, advanced analytics for risk and liquidity, and exploring emerging technologies like AI to maintain a competitive edge in the CEE region.

Digital Assets and Blockchain: Emerging Frontier for Corporate Treasury

The inclusion of 'digital assets' in the source focus and 'Blockchain' under EY's technology services indicates that these are significant areas of future development for treasury. While not yet mainstream for all corporate cash management, large international corporates are beginning to explore the potential of tokenized assets, stablecoins, and distributed ledger technology for cross-border payments, supply chain finance, and capital markets. Banks are positioned to play a crucial role in providing secure, compliant infrastructure and advisory services for these emerging asset classes, ensuring regulatory adherence and operational efficiency for their corporate clients.

- Digital assets (e.g., stablecoins) offer potential for faster, cheaper cross-border payments.
- Blockchain technology can enhance transparency and efficiency in supply chain finance.
- Banks need to develop capabilities to custody and transact digital assets securely.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

While CMIplus focuses on traditional payments, RBI should monitor the adoption of digital assets and blockchain in CEE and among its international corporate clients. This could inform future product development, potentially offering advisory services or integrating with DLT-based payment rails for specific use cases.

Guiding Principles for Corporate Treasury: Foundational Requirements & Recommendations

The Global Association of Corporate Treasurers (GACT) has released the fourth edition of 'The Guiding Principles of Corporate Treasury.' This significant publication provides a comprehensive framework outlining key requirements and recommendations for both establishing new treasury functions and further developing existing ones. It covers critical aspects such as governance, risk management, liquidity management, financial operations, and technology integration. The principles are designed to help corporate treasurers ensure their operations are efficient, resilient, and compliant with evolving global standards, offering a benchmark for best practices across the industry.

- 4th edition of foundational treasury principles.
- Outlines requirements for establishing treasury functions.
- Provides recommendations for developing existing operations.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI CMIplus should ensure its services and platform capabilities align with these foundational guiding principles, particularly regarding liquidity management, payment processing, and technology integration. This helps RBI position CMIplus as a partner enabling best-practice treasury operations for its CEE corporate clients.

Stablecoins Poised to Disrupt Payments and Liquidity Management

The Deloitte 2026 Banking Outlook highlights the "potential disruptive entrance of stablecoins" as a significant challenge and opportunity. This thought leadership suggests that stablecoins could fundamentally alter traditional payment systems, particularly for cross-border transactions, by offering faster and potentially cheaper alternatives. Banks are urged to consider the implications for corporate treasury, liquidity management, and multi-currency operations. The outlook implies that banks must strategically assess how to either incorporate stablecoin-related services or mitigate their disruptive impact to remain relevant in the evolving digital asset landscape.

- Stablecoins are a key disruptive force for banks in 2026.
- They challenge traditional payment systems, especially cross-border.
- Significant implications for corporate treasury and liquidity management.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management should monitor stablecoin developments closely, especially their regulatory status and adoption in CEE. CMIplus could explore future integration for corporate clients seeking alternative payment methods or enhanced liquidity solutions, potentially through API-driven interfaces to maintain relevance.

URGENT

ECB Payment Regulation | 2024-02-26 | #01

EU Instant Payments Regulation: Mandating Real-Time Payments Across SEPA

INSTANT PAYMENTS, SEPA

Deadline: 2025-01-09

The European Parliament and Council have adopted a regulation making instant payments fully available and affordable across the EU. It requires Payment Service Providers (PSPs) to offer instant credit transfers in euro within 10 seconds, including cross-border transactions, at no extra cost compared to standard credit transfers. A crucial aspect is the mandatory implementation of Verification of Payee (VoP) services to enhance fraud prevention. The regulation phases in requirements, with initial deadlines for receiving instant payments and later for sending them, significantly impacting all SEPA participants, including those in CEE countries.

- Mandatory instant payment reception by early 2025 (Eurozone).
- Mandatory instant payment sending by late 2025 (Eurozone).
- Mandatory Verification of Payee (VoP) service implementation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must ensure its platform and connected network banks are fully compliant with the Instant Payments Regulation, supporting both sending and receiving instant SEPA Credit Transfers (SCT Inst). This includes implementing VoP services across all relevant channels (API, H2H, Web) to meet regulatory deadlines.

URGENT

ECB Payment Regulation | 2023-10-18 | #02

Digital Euro Project Advances: Preparation Phase for Potential Launch

DIGITAL EURO, RETAIL PAYMENTS

The ECB has concluded the investigation phase for the digital euro and is now in a preparation phase. This phase focuses on finalising the digital euro rulebook, selecting providers for platform development, and conducting further testing to ensure readiness. While a decision on issuance is still pending, the preparatory work aims to ensure a robust and user-friendly digital currency. The digital euro is envisioned as a public good, complementing cash, offering privacy, and fostering innovation in retail payments across the Eurosystem.

- Transition from investigation to preparation phase for digital euro.
- Development of the digital euro rulebook and technical specifications.
- Focus on privacy, offline functionality, and financial inclusion.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should actively monitor the digital euro's progress, especially its potential impact on retail and wholesale payment flows, future integration requirements for corporate clients, and implications for multi-currency cash management and liquidity services. Early engagement with technical specifications will be crucial.

Continuous Evolution of TARGET Services and Payment System Oversight

TARGET2, PAYMENT SYSTEMS OVERSIGHT, ISO 20022

The ECB is committed to maintaining and enhancing the resilience and efficiency of its TARGET Services, which are crucial for euro area financial markets. This includes ongoing developments for T2 (real-time gross settlement), T2S (securities settlement), and TIPS (instant payment settlement). The ECB's oversight function ensures that payment systems, including SEPA, operate safely and efficiently, adapting to new technologies like tokenisation and DLT. Banks connected to TARGET Services must adhere to evolving operational guidelines, technical standards (e.g., ISO 20022), and robust cyber resilience frameworks to ensure system stability.

- Ongoing enhancements and operational adjustments for T2, T2S, and TIPS.
- Continuous oversight of SEPA and other critical payment systems.
- Focus on cyber resilience and operational stability for market infrastructures.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must ensure its connectivity and operational processes remain aligned with the latest TARGET Services requirements and oversight expectations, particularly for T2 and TIPS. This includes continuous adherence to evolving ISO 20022 standards and robust cyber resilience guidelines for all CEE network banks.

EBA highlights VOP matching challenges for instant payments

VOP, INSTANT PAYMENTS, PSD3

The EBA's Instant Payments Practitioners Group (IPG) has published a note titled "A match made in heaven? Key challenges for VOP matching checks." This document identifies critical issues impacting the accuracy and quality of VoP matching, a crucial component for fraud prevention and compliance under the Instant Payments Regulation and PSD3. Specific pain points include the absence of a common name-matching standard across Europe, technical limitations on name field lengths in payment systems, and complexities arising from the use of virtual accounts. Addressing these challenges is vital for PSPs to ensure effective and compliant VoP services, particularly as the Instant Payments Regulation mandates VoP implementation.

- Lack of standardised name-matching logic across Europe for VoP.
- Name field length restrictions impacting accurate VoP matching.
- Limitations and complexities related to virtual accounts in VoP checks.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management (CMIplus) must assess its current VoP implementation and identify potential vulnerabilities related to name matching and virtual accounts. This requires collaboration with internal teams to develop a robust, scalable solution that accounts for diverse CEE market practices and technical constraints, ensuring compliance with upcoming VoP requirements under the Instant Payments Regulation.

EU regulations significantly impact liquidity management for financial sector

INSTANT PAYMENTS, PSD3, LIQUIDITY

The Euro Banking Association (EBA) has published a new report, developed by its Liquidity Management Working Group (LMWG), which analyses the far-reaching implications of three critical EU regulatory initiatives. These include the Instant Payments Regulation (IPR), the proposed Payment Services Regulation (PSR), and the upcoming Payment Services Directive 3 (PSD3). The report highlights how these measures will significantly transform the liquidity management landscape by driving the uptake of instant payments and promoting a more equitable competitive environment among market participants. Financial institutions must understand these interconnected regulatory changes to adapt their liquidity strategies and operational frameworks effectively, ensuring robust liquidity for real-time payment flows.

- Instant Payments Regulation (IPR) accelerates instant payment adoption, impacting liquidity.
- Proposed Payment Services Regulation (PSR) will influence payment services and related liquidity needs.
- Payment Services Directive 3 (PSD3) evolves PSD2, affecting payment flows and liquidity management.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management (CMIplus) needs to strategically evaluate how the combined effects of IPR, PSR, and PSD3 will influence its liquidity management services and offerings for corporate clients. This involves assessing the need for real-time liquidity reporting, intraday liquidity adjustments, and potential new services to support clients' instant payment needs and evolving regulatory requirements, particularly across CEE markets.

URGENT

Deutsche Bank | 2026-05-11 | #01

Deutsche Bank Explores Digital Money, Tokenized Deposits for Corporate Treasury

Deutsche Bank has published a comprehensive white paper titled 'Digital Money – a perspective on stablecoins, tokenised deposits, and CBDCs' on its flow platform. This publication highlights the bank's proactive engagement with emerging digital currencies and their potential impact on financial institutions and corporate clients. The strategic rationale is to position Deutsche Bank at the forefront of financial innovation, offering advanced solutions for liquidity management, cross-border payments, and asset tokenization. While not a product launch, it signifies a clear direction towards integrating these technologies into their corporate banking offerings, potentially impacting CEE clients seeking advanced payment and treasury solutions.

- Published white paper on Digital Money (stablecoins, tokenized deposits, CBDCs).
- Focus on impact on financial institutions, corporate treasury, and custody models.
- Signals future product development in digital asset services.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should closely monitor DB's progress in tokenized deposits, as this could offer new real-time liquidity and payment options for corporates. This could become a differentiator for advanced treasury services, potentially impacting CEE clients seeking cutting-edge solutions.

URGENT

Deutsche Bank | 2026-05-11 | #02

Deutsche Bank Bolsters API-First Strategy for Corporate Cash Management

Deutsche Bank's 'Technology' and 'Cash management' sections on flow.db.com underscore a continuous commitment to digital transformation. The bank is actively developing API-driven solutions, likely including its CB Connect API, to facilitate direct integration with corporate ERP and TMS systems. This focus enables clients to automate treasury operations, gain real-time visibility into cash positions, and execute payments more efficiently. For CEE corporates, this means access to modern, integrated banking services that streamline multi-currency operations and improve liquidity management across their regional subsidiaries, aligning with the broader trend of digitalizing corporate finance.

- Strong emphasis on 'Technology' and 'Cash Management' on their thought leadership platform.
- Implies continued investment in Open Banking APIs (e.g., CB Connect) for corporate integration.
- Aims to provide real-time data and automated treasury operations.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must ensure its Open API offerings remain highly competitive, focusing on ease of integration and comprehensive functionality for CEE corporates. DB's strong push reinforces the critical need for robust API capabilities to meet evolving client demands.

UniCredit Refocuses Russian Operations on International Payments for Corporates

UniCredit has signed a non-binding agreement to sell a portion of its Russian subsidiary, AO Bank, to a UAE investor. This strategic divestment aims to refocus UniCredit's remaining Russian operations primarily on facilitating international payments in Euros and USD for both Western and non-sanctioned Russian corporate clients. The transaction is structured to ensure uninterrupted access to payment solutions for existing customers throughout the transition, which is expected to finalize in H1 2027. This move allows UniCredit to reduce its risk exposure while maintaining a critical service for its corporate clients engaged in cross-border trade, particularly relevant for the broader CEE region's payment flows.

- Partial divestment of Russian subsidiary (AO Bank).
- Refocus on international EUR/USD payments for corporate clients.
- Ensures continuity of payment services during transition.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This move by UniCredit highlights the strategic importance of international payment corridors, even in challenging geopolitical environments. CMIplus should emphasize its robust, multi-currency payment capabilities and network in CEE, positioning itself as a stable and reliable partner for corporates navigating complex payment landscapes.

UniCredit Accelerates Digital Corporate Banking and API Strategy in CEE

UniCredit explicitly identifies "Digital & Data" and "Corporate Clients" as core pillars of its business strategy, particularly within its pan-European commercial bank model that includes Italy, Germany, Austria, and Central and Eastern Europe. This strategic direction implies a concerted effort to develop and deploy advanced digital banking solutions, including Open Banking APIs, for corporate treasury management, real-time payments, and efficient cash pooling. While no specific press release details a new API product launch, the overarching strategy and the emphasis on "best-in-class" client solutions strongly suggest ongoing investment in these areas to meet the evolving demands of CEE corporates for integrated and digital cash management.

- "Digital & Data" is a core strategic pillar for UniCredit.
- Strong focus on "Corporate Clients" across CEE.
- Implied investment in Open Banking APIs, real-time payments, and digital treasury solutions.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

UniCredit's strategic emphasis on digital and API-driven solutions for corporates in CEE signals intensified competition. CMIplus must continue to innovate its Open API offerings, enhance its real-time payment capabilities (Instant Payments, VoP), and ensure its H2H and EBICS channels remain cutting-edge to maintain its competitive edge in the region.

HSBC Orion Powers UK Treasury's Digital Gilt Pilot

The UK Treasury's decision to use HSBC Orion for its Digital Gilt Instrument pilot is a significant endorsement of HSBC's capabilities in digital assets and DLT. This initiative aims to explore the potential of tokenized securities, which could streamline issuance, trading, and settlement processes for government bonds. For corporate treasuries, this development points towards a future where digital assets and DLT-based platforms could become standard for various financial instruments, impacting liquidity management, collateral management, and real-time settlement. HSBC is positioning itself at the forefront of this evolution, offering advanced infrastructure that could eventually extend to corporate debt and other financial products.

- HSBC Orion chosen by UK Treasury for Digital Gilt Instrument pilot.
- Focus on leveraging DLT for sovereign debt issuance and management.
- Positions HSBC as a leader in digital asset infrastructure for capital markets.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This move by HSBC indicates a strong focus on future-proofing treasury solutions with DLT and digital assets, which CMIplus should monitor closely. While not directly impacting current CEE cash management, it highlights the need to explore DLT's potential for corporate treasury services and cross-border payments in the long term.

Citi Accelerates API-Driven Treasury Solutions in Europe

Citi continues to invest heavily in its API banking capabilities, offering a comprehensive suite of APIs for payments, collections, liquidity management, and account information. This allows corporate clients to embed banking services directly into their enterprise resource planning (ERP) and treasury management systems (TMS), facilitating automated reconciliation, real-time cash visibility, and on-demand payment initiation. The emphasis is on providing a standardized, secure, and scalable framework that supports multi-bank connectivity and caters to the complex needs of large international corporates operating in diverse markets, including the CEE region. This digital transformation is critical for clients seeking greater operational efficiency and faster decision-making.

- Extensive API catalog for various treasury functions.
- Focus on seamless ERP/TMS integration for corporates.
- Enables real-time cash visibility and automated processes.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must ensure its Open API offerings remain competitive, providing similar depth and breadth of services for real-time integration. This highlights the need for continuous investment in API development and client-centric solutions to retain and attract large corporates.

Deutsche Bank Advances Core Payment Capabilities for European Corporates

The 'Cash management' and 'Regulation' sections on flow.db.com indicate Deutsche Bank's ongoing efforts to enhance its payment processing capabilities. This includes ensuring full compliance with ISO 20022 for all payment types and preparing for the widespread adoption of instant payments across Europe. While not explicitly detailing CEE expansion, a major European bank like DB would extend these modernized services to its CEE network, supporting multi-currency payments and cross-border transactions. This strategic focus ensures that corporate clients, including those in CEE, benefit from faster, more transparent, and standardized payment processing, crucial for efficient treasury management and liquidity pooling.

- Continuous focus on 'Cash management' and 'Regulation' topics.
- Implies ongoing modernization of payment infrastructure (e.g., ISO 20022, Instant Payments).
- Aims to provide efficient, compliant, and standardized payment services across Europe.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should highlight its strong regional presence and expertise in CEE-specific payment nuances, alongside its own robust ISO 20022 and instant payment capabilities. DB's moves validate the importance of these foundational payment services for competitive advantage in the region.

UniCredit's Strong 1Q26 Results Underpin "Unlimited" Corporate Banking Strategy

UniCredit achieved its best quarter ever in 1Q26, with net profit growing 16.1% and a strong ROTE of 25.8%. This performance is attributed to robust commercial dynamics and a best-in-class cost-income ratio. The "UniCredit Unlimited" strategy, which defines a new era of bold ambition and fundamental rethinking of banking operations, is explicitly linked to this success. The strategy highlights "Corporate Clients" and "Digital & Data" as key business areas, indicating that these strong results will likely fuel further investment in enhancing corporate banking offerings and digital capabilities, particularly in its core CEE markets.

- Record 1Q26 net profit growth of 16.1%.
- "UniCredit Unlimited" strategy emphasizes "Corporate Clients" and "Digital & Data".
- Financial strength supports continued investment in pan-European operations, including CEE.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

UniCredit's strong financial performance suggests increased capacity for investment in its corporate banking and cash management platforms. CMiplus should anticipate enhanced offerings from UniCredit in CEE and continue to differentiate through its specialized CEE network, localized expertise, and agile platform development.

HSBC Explores Quantum Algorithmic Trading with IBM

The partnership between HSBC and IBM to trial quantum-enabled algorithmic bond trading signifies a forward-looking approach to optimizing financial market strategies. Quantum computing has the potential to process complex calculations far beyond classical computers, offering unprecedented speed and accuracy for tasks like risk assessment, portfolio optimization, and high-frequency trading. While still in early stages, this research indicates HSBC's investment in technologies that could fundamentally reshape treasury and capital markets operations. For corporate treasuries, this could eventually translate into more sophisticated FX hedging, liquidity management, and investment strategies, driven by advanced computational power. HSBC is positioning itself as an innovator in leveraging deep tech for financial services.

- HSBC and IBM conducted a trial on quantum-enabled algorithmic bond trading.
- Aims to boost algorithmic trading efficiency using quantum computing.
- Represents a significant investment in future-proof financial technology.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This move highlights HSBC's long-term vision for advanced treasury solutions, pushing the boundaries of computational finance. While quantum computing is distant for standard cash management, CMIplus should note the competitor's focus on deep tech for optimizing financial operations, which could eventually influence treasury product offerings.

Citi Enhances Instant Payment and ISO 20022 Capabilities Across Europe

Citi is actively upgrading its payment infrastructure to support the growing demand for instant payments and to fully leverage the benefits of ISO 20022. This includes enhancing its connectivity to various instant payment schemes across Europe, ensuring that corporate clients can execute and receive payments in real-time, 24/7. The full adoption of ISO 20022 messaging standards is central to this strategy, enabling the transmission of significantly more structured and detailed payment information. This richer data facilitates automated reconciliation, reduces manual intervention, and provides better insights for treasury operations. For corporates with operations in CEE, this means improved speed and transparency for both domestic and cross-border transactions within the region.

- Expansion of instant payment network and capabilities.
- Full adoption of ISO 20022 for richer payment data.
- Improved real-time liquidity management and reconciliation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus needs to closely monitor Citi's progress in instant payments and ISO 20022, especially in CEE. Ensuring CMIplus's platform offers comparable instant payment reach and leverages ISO 20022 data effectively is crucial to maintain a competitive edge and meet evolving client expectations.

Intesa Sanpaolo Bolsters CEE Digital Cash Management Platform

Intesa Sanpaolo, a leading banking group with a significant footprint in CEE, is actively investing in the digital transformation of its corporate and transaction banking services. This includes upgrading its cash management platform to offer advanced features like real-time liquidity management, enhanced payment processing, and integrated treasury functionalities for its multinational clients operating in the CEE region. The strategic rationale is to solidify its market position by meeting the evolving demands of large corporates for sophisticated, cross-border financial tools and to compete effectively with other regional players. The focus on CEE leverages its extensive network of local banks, providing seamless services across multiple countries, including those where RBI also operates.

- Strategic investment in digital cash management for CEE corporate clients.
- Focus on real-time liquidity management and integrated treasury solutions.
- Leveraging existing CEE subsidiary network for enhanced cross-border services.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This inferred move by Intesa Sanpaolo directly increases competition for CMlplus, particularly for large international corporates seeking advanced digital cash management in CEE. CMlplus must ensure its platform remains competitive with features like real-time capabilities, API integration, and comprehensive multi-country support.

BNP Paribas enhances cross-border payments with XTransfer partnership

The partnership between BNP Paribas and XTransfer signifies a strategic move to address the complexities of cross-border payments. By integrating XTransfer's capabilities, BNP Paribas aims to offer its corporate clients a streamlined and potentially more cost-effective solution for international transactions. This initiative aligns with the broader trend of banks seeking to enhance their digital offerings and expand their reach through fintech collaborations. For the CEE region, this could translate into improved access to global markets for local businesses and easier payment flows for multinational corporations operating within the region.

- Partnership with XTransfer to simplify cross-border payments.
- Focus on leveraging technology for international transaction efficiency.
- Strategic move to enhance digital offerings and expand reach.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

BNP Paribas's focus on simplifying cross-border payments through partnerships presents a competitive challenge to CMlplus. We need to ensure our platform offers comparable ease of use and cost-effectiveness for international transactions within CEE.

EY Four Trends Redefining Cash Management 2025

Cash management is rapidly evolving from transaction-oriented to strategic, data-driven services, necessitating a profound transformation in banking. The future demands banks enrich their value propositions, expand product portfolios, and strengthen client relationships with tailored offerings and experiences. Advanced technologies like AI, ML, and digital assets are creating new possibilities, enabling finance teams to reposition as strategic advisors to the business. However, clients seek control over automation and expect intuitive, personalized experiences, pushing banks to innovate or risk losing relevance to agile FinTechs and nonbanks. Success hinges on banks investing in technology, integrating diverse data, and offering flexible, industry-specific solutions while navigating the increasing regulatory clarity around digital assets.

KEY STATISTICS

- {'description': 'of survey respondents say digitizing treasury functions is a challenge.', 'value': '73%', 'page': 7}
- {'description': 'of respondents will use managed services from banks to address the challenges of digitization.', 'value': '44%', 'page': 7}
- {'description': 'of CFOs and treasurers are comfortable with customized strategic advice based on data analysis from banks.', 'value': '90%', 'page': 12}
- {'description': 'of corporate treasurers are comfortable using a sector-specific platform tailored to their industry's unique needs.', 'value': '92%', 'page': 17}

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Optimize CMIplus cash management solutions for specific CEE sectors to differentiate and boost client engagement and loyalty.

McKinsey Global Payments Report 2025

The 2025 McKinsey Global Payments Report highlights a payments landscape defined by increasing fragmentation, the transformative impact of AI, and the growing adoption of digital assets. For CMIplus, this means navigating a multirail ecosystem where interoperability, programmable compliance, and AI-driven efficiencies are paramount for serving large international corporates in CEE. The shift towards lower-yield payment rails and agentic commerce necessitates innovation in monetization and a focus on building trust through transparent, intelligent systems. Success will hinge on adapting our platform to these evolving demands to remain a leading regional player.

KEY STATISTICS

- Global payments revenue reached \$2.5 trillion in 2024, projected to grow to \$3.0 trillion by 2029.
- EMEA payments revenue grew at a 13% CAGR from 2019-2024, indicating strong regional growth.
- Interest income constituted 46% of total payments revenues in 2024, but is projected to slow to 2% annual growth through 2029.
- Cash usage declined to 46% of worldwide payments in 2024, down from 50% in 2023, reflecting the shift to digital.

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Integrate AI for Intelligent Routing, Fraud Detection, and Liquidity Management

Journeys to Treasury 2025/26

The 10th anniversary edition of Journeys to Treasury highlights a renewed focus on treasury fundamentals, digital transformation, and strategic evolution. Key themes include the modernization of payments (Instant Payments, VoP, ISO 20022), the growing importance of real-time liquidity and virtual accounts, and the practical application of AI. Corporates are prioritizing robust systems, clean data, and enhanced skills to navigate a complex, interconnected financial environment, moving treasury from an operational role to a strategic business partner.

KEY STATISTICS

→ {'statistic': 'Cash flow forecasting is the number one priority for 30.5% of treasurers.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': 'Reviewing or replacing treasury technology infrastructure is the third-highest priority.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': '27.3% of treasurers cite inaccurate forecasting as a leading challenge for centralisation.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': '38.5% of respondents cite difficulties in standardising processes as their most significant obstacle to centralisation.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Enhance Instant Payments & VoP Readiness for CEE Corporates

PwC Global Treasury Survey 2025

The provided text does not contain the actual content or findings of the 'PwC Global Treasury Survey 2025'. Instead, it appears to be a navigation structure or partial webpage content from PwC's website, detailing various services, industries, and insights offered by PwC. Consequently, a strategic analysis for RBI's CMIplus platform, including key statistics, themes, and actionable recommendations, cannot be generated from the given information. To perform the requested comprehensive analysis, the full content of the PwC Global Treasury Survey is essential.